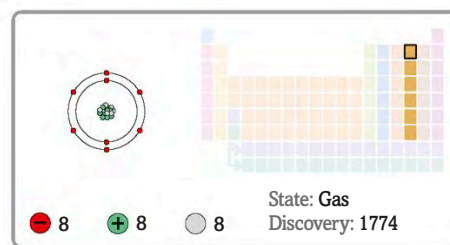
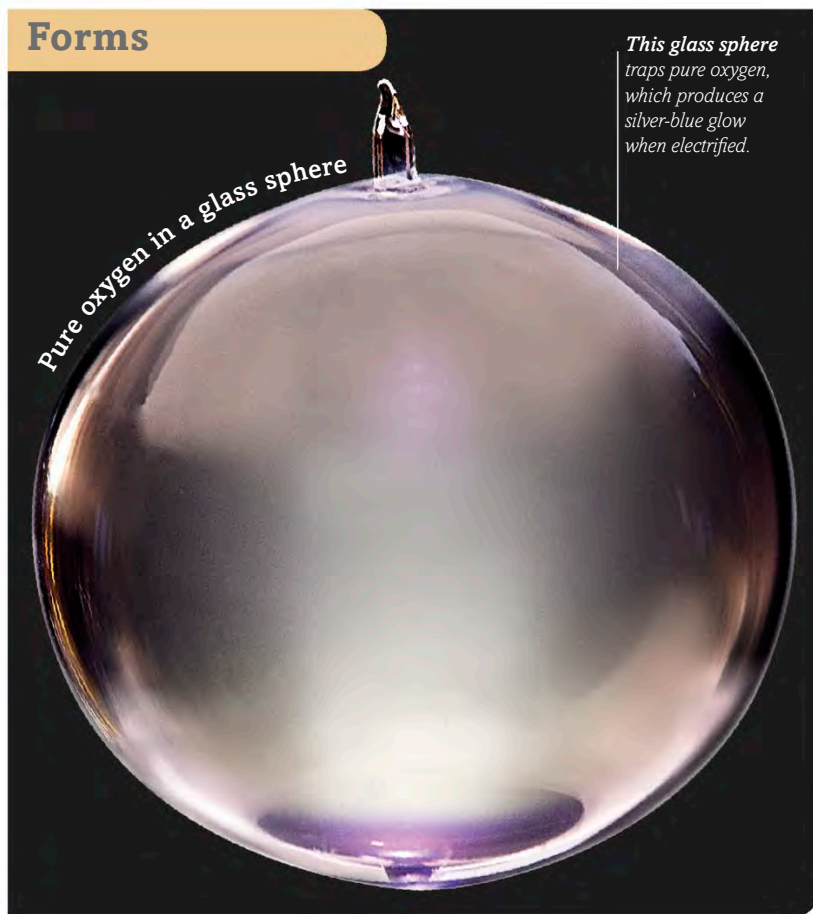


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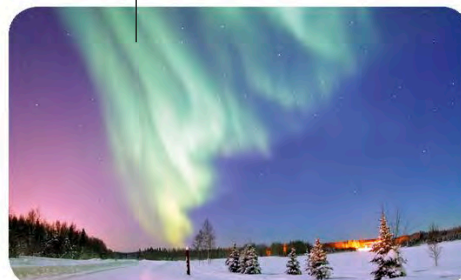
Oxygen



Forms



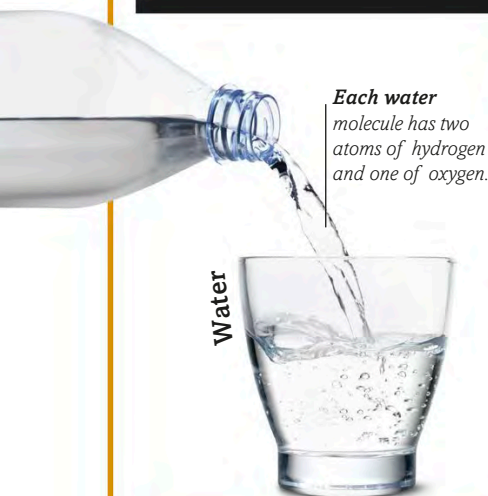
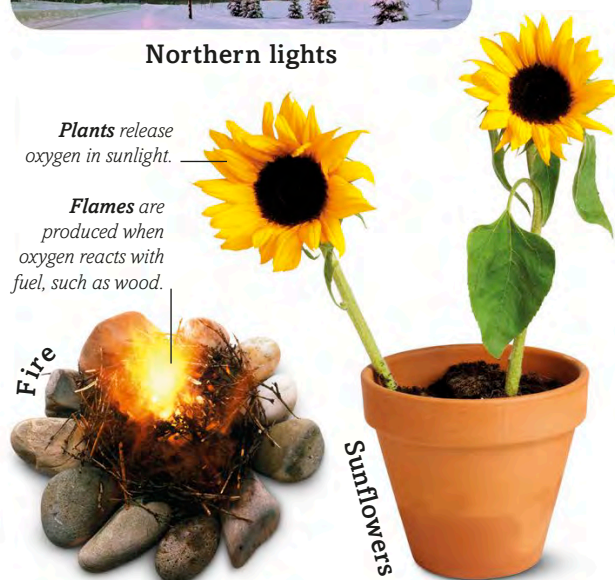
Streaks of light adorn the sky as atoms of oxygen in the air are hit by a stream of particles blasting from the Sun.



Northern lights

Plants release oxygen in sunlight.

Flames are produced when oxygen reacts with fuel, such as wood.



WHAT IS COMBUSTION?

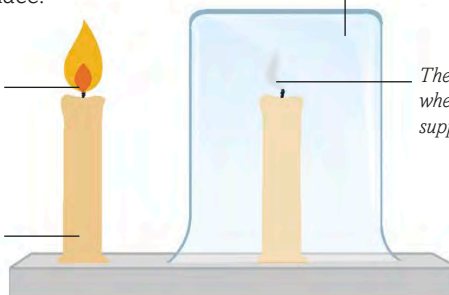
Combustion is a chemical reaction that produces heat and light. Oxygen is essential for combustion to take place.

The flame is steady in the presence of oxygen.

Candle wax is made of a flammable carbon compound, which acts as a fuel.

A beaker is placed over a candle, starving the flame of oxygen.

The flame goes out when the oxygen supply is cut off.



Oxygen is the most common element in Earth's crust. Oxygen and its compounds make up half of all rocks and minerals on our planet. In the atmosphere, **pure oxygen** makes up around one-fifth of the air. This element is a transparent gas. Life on Earth depends on

oxygen for survival. Animals breathe in air to collect the oxygen in it. Our bodies' cells then use that oxygen to break apart sugars to release energy, which powers our bodies. Another process that involves oxygen is the burning reaction called combustion, in which oxygen